

SKOAR!

MURDERED

SOUL SUSPECT

Siddharth "staticsid" Parwatay
siddharth.parwatay@digit.in

Murdered: Soul Suspect is a game rife with "what ifs" and "if onlys". What if they'd just utilised the game mechanics better? If only you could follow multiple paths? What if the mystery itself was more gripping? If only these (and many other) whatifs had been addressed the game would've made for much more compelling experience, but as it stands, not so much.



The prologue of Murdered serves to establish the setting of the game: you are a fedora wearing and downright badly dressed ex-con turned cop who is hot on the trail of a vicious serial killer. Following an anonymous tip you end up at an apartment building where the said suspect throws you out of a fourth floor window. For good measure he even pumps six bullets into your chest leaving you obviously dead. But the story doesn't end there, in fact

that's where it begins. Following a few ghost movie cliches where you try to punch people and swing right through them, you realise you're now a ghost and hence jump headlong into an other-worldly investigation to discover the identity of your murderer.

The actual mystery solving process is rather unchallenging. You look around the crime scene like you would in any point-and-click thriller, discover objects that have an obvious glow around them (indicating that they're important), and add them to your cache of clues. To move the story forward you put together a handful of relevant clues to answer questions pertaining to the investigation. Now here's the kicker - you can do this any number of times; there's no penalty. So, by a process of trial, error and elimination you can eventually solve the question no matter what.

Game mechanics

The game does have a few interesting "firsts" so to say. For one thing the ability to influence people by possessing them is interesting. However, like most things in Soul Suspects, this too could've been used in a better way but we'll keep that crib aside for now. The ability to walk through walls also fits in well with the whole ghostly theme. As for enemies you have dementor like creatures who can potentially kill you. The only way to escape them is to hide in

wisps of ghost residue. To kill them you need to creep up behind them and initiate an execute sequence – this bit does add an element of stealth to the game.

Verdict

The one overarching sentiment from playing Murdered: Soul Suspect is that it is inspiringly uninteresting. The game would only appeal to really young audiences who will perhaps be taken in by the insipid attempts at creating a spooky atmosphere. For us, it wasn't gripping enough to continue to the story's end. *

REVIEWED ON:

- Intel Core i7 2600K @ 3.40GHz
- Kingston Hyperx Beast 16GB Dual-Channel DDR3
- ASRock Z68 Extreme7 Gen3
- 2047MB NVIDIA GeForce GTX 560
- DELL S2740L (1920x1080@60Hz)
- 600GB WD Velociraptor
- 120 GB ADATA SSD
- ASUS Xonar Essence STX
- Windows 7 Ultimate 64-bit SP1

MOAR!

Developer: Airtight Games

Publisher: Square Enix

Platforms: PC, PS 3, PS

4, Xbox 360, Xbox One

Contact: info@expressgames.in

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